

THE KNOWLEDGE FORUM KERALA

GANDHI JAYANTI QUIZ 2026

OFFICIAL STUDY MODULE

2 OCTOBER 2026

An official study guide covering key information about Mahatma Gandhi's life, philosophy, the Indian freedom struggle, and his connections with Kerala, designed for quiz preparation.

PAGE 2: HOW TO USE THIS MODULE

This module is not a comprehensive history textbook but a Quick Reference Guide tailored for participants preparing for the Gandhi Jayanti General Quiz 2026.

- **Open to All:** This quiz is not restricted to students; teachers, working professionals, senior citizens, and general quiz enthusiasts may participate.
- **Question Scope:** The quiz questions will be primarily based on the facts, dates, personalities, and events outlined in this module.
- **Preparation Strategy:** Rather than memorizing long paragraphs, focus on understanding the associations between years, places, and people.

HOW TO PREPARE:

- Pay close attention to the tables and timelines.
- Study using the "Name → Event → Year" association method.
- Give special priority to the sections on Gandhi's visits to Kerala and the Vaikom Satyagraha.

PAGE 3: GANDHI — EARLY LIFE

Mahatma Gandhi's birth, childhood, and education are foundational topics for quiz questions.

- **Full Name:** Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
- **Date of Birth:** 2 October 1869
- **Birthplace:** Porbandar, Gujarat. The house where he was born is now known as Kirti Mandir.
- **Parents:** Karamchand Gandhi (Kaba Gandhi) and Putlibai. Karamchand served as the Diwan (Chief Minister) of Porbandar and Rajkot.
- **Wife:** Kasturba (Married in 1883 when Gandhi was 13 years old).

- **Children:** Harilal, Manilal, Ramdas, Devadas.
- **Early Influences:** Childhood plays such as Shravana Pitrubhakti Nataka and Harishchandra left a profound impact on him.
- **Education:** Alfred High School (Rajkot) and Samaldas College (Bhavnagar).
- **London Years (1888–1891):** Travelled to London to study law. He earned his law degree (Barrister) from the Inner Temple. During his time in London, he joined the Vegetarian Society.

PAGE 4: GANDHI IN SOUTH AFRICA

In 1893, Gandhi went to South Africa to represent a Gujarati merchant named Dada Abdullah in a legal dispute. He remained there until 1914. It was here that his weapon of 'Satyagraha' was born.

- **Pietermaritzburg Incident (7 June 1893):** While travelling from Durban to Pretoria, Gandhi was thrown out of a first-class train compartment at Pietermaritzburg station due to racial discrimination, despite holding a valid ticket. This was the turning point in his life.
- **Natal Indian Congress (1894):** An organization founded by Gandhi to protect the rights of Indians in South Africa.
- **Birth of Satyagraha (11 September 1906):** Gandhi first used 'Satyagraha' in Johannesburg to protest the Transvaal government's Asiatic Registration Act (often called the Black Act).

KEY ASSOCIATIONS (PERSON / PLACE / EVENT)

Subject	Significance
Indian Opinion (1903)	The newspaper started by Gandhi in South Africa.
Phoenix Settlement (1904)	The first ashram established by Gandhi, located in Durban.
Tolstoy Farm (1910)	The second ashram built for Satyagrahis near Johannesburg. The land was donated by his friend Hermann Kallenbach.

PAGE 5: RETURN TO INDIA + EARLY SATYAGRAHAS

Following his successful campaigns in South Africa, Gandhi returned to India.

- **Return (9 January 1915):** The day Gandhi arrived in Bombay is now commemorated annually as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (Non-Resident Indian Day).
- **Political Guru:** Gopal Krishna Gokhale. Gokhale advised Gandhi to spend his first year travelling across India to understand the country's real conditions.

- **First Ashram (1915):** Established the Kochrab Ashram in Ahmedabad. In 1917, it was relocated to the banks of the Sabarmati river and renamed Sabarmati Ashram.

EARLY SATYAGRAHAS (TIMELINE)

Year	Place & Event	Key Quiz Points
1917	Champanan Satyagraha	The first Satyagraha in India. Fought for the Indigo farmers in Bihar. A farmer named Rajkumar Shukla invited Gandhi here.
1918	Ahmedabad Mill Strike	Fought for a wage increase for mill workers. This was the first time Gandhi used the Hunger Strike weapon in India.
1918	Kheda Satyagraha	A no-tax campaign in Gujarat for farmers facing crop failure. This struggle highlighted the leadership skills of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

PAGE 6: MAJOR FREEDOM MOVEMENTS

Movement	Year	Where / What Happened?	Quiz Significance
Rowlatt Satyagraha	1919	An all-India protest against the oppressive British Rowlatt Act.	Gandhi's first nationwide call to action. It set the background for the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (13 April 1919).
Non-Cooperation Movement	1920	Boycott of government titles, courts, schools, and foreign clothes. Aligned with the Khilafat Movement.	India's first major mass movement.
Chauri Chaura Incident	1922	A mob set fire to a police station in Chauri Chaura, U.P.	Due to this violence, Gandhi called off the Non-Cooperation Movement in February 1922.
Dandi March / Salt Satyagraha	1930	A 385 km march from Sabarmati to Dandi (March 12 - April 6) to break the salt law.	Marked the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement. 78 followers marched with him.
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	1931	An agreement signed between Gandhi and Viceroy Lord Irwin.	Led to Gandhi travelling to London to attend the Second Round Table Conference.
Poona Pact	1932		

		An agreement between Gandhi and B.R. Ambedkar signed at Yerwada Jail.	Reached after Gandhi fasted against the British announcement of separate electorates for depressed classes.
Quit India Movement	1942	Launched on August 8 at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay, demanding the British leave India.	Gandhi gave his famous "Do or Die" call during this movement.

PAGE 7: GANDHI'S IDEAS & KEY TERMS

Understanding the meaning behind Gandhian terms is vital for quiz preparation.

- **Satya (Truth):** For Gandhi, "Truth is God."
- **Ahimsa (Non-violence):** Not hurting others in thought, word, or deed. The foundational pillar of his struggles.
- **Satyagraha:** "Truth-force" or soul-force. A method of non-violent resistance against injustice.
- **Swaraj (Self-rule):** Gandhi believed true Swaraj meant self-control and self-governance, not just political freedom from the British.
- **Swadeshi:** Using locally produced goods. Relying on and promoting a neighbour's labour.
- **Khadi:** To Gandhi, Khadi was not just a cloth; it was a symbol of self-reliance and the eradication of poverty.
- **Sarvodaya:** "Universal uplift" or progress for all. He adopted this concept from John Ruskin's book *Unto This Last*.
- **Constructive Programme:** An 18-point plan for social reconstruction alongside political freedom, focusing on eradicating untouchability, Hindu-Muslim unity, women's empowerment, and prohibition.

PAGE 8: BOOKS, WRITINGS & JOURNALS

Gandhi's literary contributions and journalism are frequently tested in quizzes.

MAJOR BOOKS

Book Title	Significance / Quiz Point
The Story of My Experiments with Truth	Gandhi's autobiography. Originally written in Gujarati. Translated into English by Mahadev Desai.
Hind Swaraj (Indian Home Rule)	Written in 1909 on a ship while returning from London to South Africa. It contains his critique of modern civilization.

Satyagraha in South Africa	Details the history of his struggle in South Africa. He began writing it in Yerwada Jail.
Key to Health	His guide on naturopathy, diet, and personal well-being.
Constructive Programme: Its Meaning and Place	A booklet outlining his programs for rebuilding India from the village level up.

MAJOR JOURNALS

- **Indian Opinion:** Started in South Africa in 1903. Published in English, Gujarati, Hindi, and Tamil.
- **Young India:** An English weekly journal he ran in India from 1919 to 1931.
- **Navajivan:** A Gujarati weekly newspaper.
- **Harijan:** An English newspaper started in 1933 dedicated to the eradication of untouchability. (He also published Harijan Bandhu in Gujarati and Harijan Sevak in Hindi).

PAGE 9: GANDHI & KERALA (THE 5 VISITS)

Gandhi visited Kerala 5 times. This is the most crucial section for a Kerala-based quiz.

Visit	Date/Year	Major Places	Purpose / Significance
First Visit	18 Aug 1920	Calicut	To campaign for the Khilafat and Non-Cooperation Movements. Khilafat leader Shaukat Ali accompanied him. Addressed a massive rally at Calicut beach.
Second Visit	8-19 March 1925	Vaikom, Ernakulam, Sivagiri	To resolve issues related to the Vaikom Satyagraha. Met with Regent Maharani Sethu Lakshmi Bayi and Police Commissioner Pitt. Met Sree Narayana Guru at Sivagiri on 12 March 1925.
Third Visit	9-25 Oct 1927	Ernakulam to Trivandrum (South Indian Tour)	Primarily for Khadi promotion. Visited Ernakulam, Kottarakkara, Kollam, and Trivandrum.
Fourth Visit	10-22 Jan 1934	Kannur to Trivandrum	For anti-untouchability campaigns and Harijan Fund collection. Visited the Mathrubhumi office (Calicut) and the Payyanur Ashram. Freedom fighter Kaumudi Teacher donated all her gold ornaments to him in Vadakara (Jan 14).

Fifth Visit	12-21 Jan 1937	Trivandrum, Kottarakkara	To participate in the celebrations of the 1936 Travancore Temple Entry Proclamation. Gandhi famously described the proclamation as a "Miracle of Modern Times."
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PAGE 10: VAIKOM + GANDHI + KERALA SPECIAL

Note: Gandhi did not start the Vaikom Satyagraha, but his intervention was critical to its successful resolution.

- **Vaikom Satyagraha (1924–1925):** A struggle for the right of marginalized castes to walk on the roads surrounding the Vaikom Mahadeva Temple. It started on 30 March 1924 (led by T.K. Madhavan, K.P. Kesava Menon, and K. Kelappan). Mannathu Padmanabhan led the 'Savarna Jatha'. Gandhi arrived in 1925 and mediated with orthodox leaders (Indanthuruthi Namboothiri). The struggle was withdrawn on 23 November 1925 after the roads were opened to all.
- **Guruvayur Satyagraha (1931-1932):** A struggle for temple entry led by K. Kelappan with Gandhi's blessing. When Kelappan went on a fast unto death, Gandhi intervened to stop it. (Gandhi did not visit Kerala during this event).
- **Payyanur:** The main center for the Salt Satyagraha in Kerala, led by K. Kelappan (known as 'Kerala Gandhi'). During his 1934 visit, Gandhi visited Swami Ananda Theerthan's ashram in Payyanur.
- **Mathrubhumi Visit:** In 1934, Gandhi visited the Mathrubhumi press in Calicut, run by K.P. Kesava Menon, to praise their nationalist efforts. He arrived at the office in a bullock cart.

PAGE 11: IMPORTANT PEOPLE

Identifying individuals associated with Gandhi is a staple in general quizzes.

Name	Connection to Gandhi
Kasturba Gandhi	His wife. She passed away on 22 February 1944 while imprisoned in the Aga Khan Palace during the Quit India Movement.
Gopal Krishna Gokhale	His political guru.
Mahadev Desai	His personal secretary for many years. Often referred to as 'Gandhi's shadow'.
Rajendra Prasad	A key aide during the Champaran Satyagraha. Later became India's first President.
Vallabhbhai Patel	His trusted lieutenant starting from the Kheda Satyagraha. Earned the title 'Sardar' after the Bardoli Satyagraha.

C. F. Andrews	A British friend Gandhi affectionately called 'Deenabandhu'. Accompanied Rabindranath Tagore to meet Sree Narayana Guru in 1922.
Mirabehn	A dedicated British follower. Her real name was Madeleine Slade.
Rajkumar Shukla	The farmer who informed Gandhi about the plight of indigo cultivators and invited him to Champaran.
Sree Narayana Guru	Held a historic meeting with Gandhi at Sivagiri on 12 March 1925. They discussed ahimsa and the caste system.
Kaumudi Teacher	The freedom fighter from Vadakara who donated all her gold ornaments to Gandhi's Harijan Fund in 1934.
K. Kelappan	Known as 'Kerala Gandhi'. He led the Salt Satyagraha and Guruvayur Satyagraha in Kerala.
A. K. Gopalan (AKG)	Served as the Volunteer Captain during the Guruvayur Satyagraha.

PAGE 12: IMPORTANT PLACES

Memorize this table for location-based questions.

Place	Gandhi Connection
Porbandar	Birthplace. The house is known as Kirti Mandir.
Rajkot	The city where Gandhi completed his high school education.
Inner Temple, London	The institution where Gandhi studied law.
Pietermaritzburg	The railway station in South Africa where he was evicted from a train due to racial discrimination.
Phoenix / Tolstoy Farm	The two ashrams Gandhi established in South Africa.
Kochrab	The site of his first ashram in India (1915) after returning from South Africa.
Sabarmati	The ashram moved here in 1917. The Dandi March commenced from this ashram.

Champaran	Site of the first Satyagraha in India (Bihar, 1917).
Dandi	A coastal village in Gujarat where he broke the salt law (1930).
Aga Khan Palace	The prison in Pune where Gandhi and Kasturba were detained during the Quit India Movement. Kasturba died here.
Birla House	The location in Delhi where Gandhi was assassinated on 30 January 1948. It is now known as Gandhi Smriti.
Rajghat	His final resting place (samadhi) on the banks of the Yamuna River in Delhi.

PAGE 13: IMPORTANT DATES & MASTER TIMELINE

- **1869 (Oct 2):** Birth.
- **1883:** Marriage to Kasturba.
- **1893:** Travelled to South Africa. The Pietermaritzburg incident occurred.
- **1894:** Founded the Natal Indian Congress.
- **1903:** Started the Indian Opinion newspaper.
- **1906:** First use of 'Satyagraha' in South Africa.
- **1909:** Wrote Hind Swaraj.
- **1915 (Jan 9):** Returned to India (commemorated as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas).
- **1917:** Champaran Satyagraha (first Satyagraha in India).
- **1918:** Ahmedabad Mill Strike and Kheda Satyagraha.
- **1919:** Rowlatt Satyagraha and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- **1920:** Launched the Non-Cooperation Movement. Undertook his first visit to Kerala (August).
- **1922:** Chauri Chaura incident. Non-Cooperation Movement suspended.
- **1924:** Elected President of the Indian National Congress at the Belgaum session. (This was the only time he served as INC President).
- **1925:** Visited the Vaikom Satyagraha site and met Sree Narayana Guru at Sivagiri.
- **1930:** Dandi March, Salt Satyagraha, and the launch of the Civil Disobedience Movement.
- **1931:** Signed the Gandhi-Irwin Pact; attended the Second Round Table Conference.
- **1932:** Signed the Poona Pact; founded the Harijan Sevak Sangh.
- **1933:** Started the Harijan newspaper.
- **1942 (Aug 8):** Launched the Quit India Movement ("Do or Die").
- **1944:** Death of Kasturba Gandhi (at Aga Khan Palace).
- **1947 (Aug 15):** Indian Independence (Gandhi was in Noakhali trying to quell communal violence).

- **1948 (Jan 30):** Assassinated by Nathuram Godse. This day is observed as Martyrs' Day.

PAGE 14: RAPID REVISION

A ONE-MINUTE REVISION section for scanning right before the quiz.

1. Important People → Nicknames / Roles

- **Political Guru** → Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- **Political Successor** → Jawaharlal Nehru
- **Mirabeau** → Madeleine Slade
- **Deenabandhu** → C. F. Andrews
- **Kerala Gandhi** → K. Kelappan
- **Frontier Gandhi** → Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
- **Bihar Gandhi** → Dr. Rajendra Prasad

2. Important Events → Years

- **Hind Swaraj Written** → 1909
- **Return to India (Pravasi Bharatiya Divas)** → 9 January 1915
- **Champaran (First Satyagraha)** → 1917
- **Chauri Chaura Incident** → 1922
- **Dandi March** → 1930 (March 12 - April 6)
- **Quit India Movement** → 8 August 1942

3. Kerala Visits → Keywords

- **1920** → Calicut, Khilafat Movement, Shaukat Ali
- **1925** → Vaikom, Meeting with Sree Narayana Guru (March 12)
- **1927** → South India Tour, Khadi Promotion
- **1934** → Harijan Fund, Payyanur, Kaumudi Teacher's ornament donation
- **1937** → Temple Entry Proclamation celebration

4. Core Associations → Meanings

- **Dandi** → Breaking the Salt Law
- **Kheda** → Farmers, No-Tax Campaign
- **Ahmedabad** → Mill workers, First Hunger Strike

- **Sardar** → Vallabhbhai Patel (earned at Bardoli)
- **Tolstoy Farm** → South Africa

PAGE 15: REFERENCE SOURCES + FINAL NOTE

The official sources used to compile and fact-check this study module are listed below:

- **Gandhi Heritage Portal (Sabarmati Ashram Preservation and Memorial Trust)**
URL: <https://www.gandhiheritageportal.org/>
- **Gandhi Smriti and Darshan Samiti (Ministry of Culture, Govt. of India)**
URL: <https://www.gandhismriti.gov.in/>
- **Information & Public Relations Department (I&PRD), Government of Kerala** (Referred for Kerala history, Vaikom Satyagraha, and Gandhi's 5 Kerala visits)
- **NCERT & SCERT Kerala Textbooks** (History textbooks)

"The questions for the quiz will be drafted based on the topics and reference sources included in this module."

(All the best to the participants of TKFK Gandhi Jayanti Quiz 2026!)